

1.3 Other Malicious Software

Earlier, the only way a computer was at risk was when you inserted an infected floppy. With the new age of technology, every computer is interconnected to the rest of the world at some point or the other, so it's difficult to pinpoint the source and/or time of the infection. As if that weren't bad enough, new-age computing has also brought about a new breed of malicious software. Today, the term 'virus' has become a generic term used for all the different ways that your computer can be attacked by malicious software. Besides the type of viruses we mentioned in Chapter 1.2, here's a look at some of the newer problems we face today.

Trojan Horses: The biggest difference between a Trojan horse—or Trojan—and a virus is that Trojans don't spread themselves. Trojan horses disguise themselves as useful software available for download on the Internet, and naïve users download and run them only to realise their mistake later.

A Trojan horse is usually divided into two parts—a server and a client. It's the client that is cunningly disguised as important soft-

